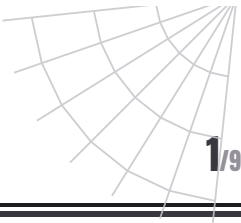


# TRICK, TREAT, PLAN.



THE NIGHT \_\_\_\_\_

Party for \_\_\_\_\_

Date \_\_\_\_\_

Doors \_\_\_\_\_ Ends \_\_\_\_\_

Where \_\_\_\_\_

Theme \_\_\_\_\_

Dress code \_\_\_\_\_

Adults \_\_\_\_\_ Kids \_\_\_\_\_

Budget \_\_\_\_\_

RSVP by \_\_\_\_\_

Playlist by \_\_\_\_\_

Who is helping \_\_\_\_\_

HANDED TO SOMEONE ELSE — Nobody hosts and answers the door

☐ \_\_\_\_\_

☐ \_\_\_\_\_

☐ \_\_\_\_\_

SCARE LEVEL \_\_\_\_\_

Decide it now; everything follows

☐

☐

☐

☐

☐

Giggles and glitter

Genuinely frightening

\_\_\_\_\_

THE ONE IMAGE PEOPLE SHOULD REMEMBER \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

COUNTDOWN \_\_\_\_\_

- ☐ 4 weeks

☐ 2 weeks
- ☐ 1 week

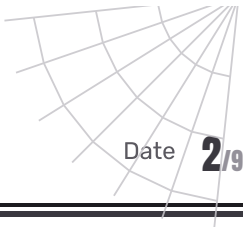
☐ The eve
- ☐ 31 October

☐ 1 November

NOTES \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

# FOUR WEEKS TO THE NIGHT.



## FOUR WEEKS OUT

- ☐ Set the date, the budget and the scare level
- ☐ Send the invitations – costumes need notice
- ☐ Order or start making costumes
- ☐ Book anything that gets booked out in October
- ☐ Decide: party, trick-or-treat, or both
- ☐
- ☐

## ONE WEEK OUT

- ☐ Chase the guests who have not replied
- ☐ Buy pumpkins – not earlier, they collapse
- ☐ Batteries, tea lights, LED candles
- ☐ Print the playlist and the games
- ☐ Clear a room for coats and one for quiet
- ☐
- ☐

## 31 OCTOBER

- ☐ Food out late, so it is not warm and sad
- ☐ Porch light on means sweets, off means done
- ☐ Photos before the make-up melts
- ☐

## TWO WEEKS OUT

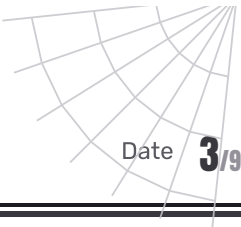
- ☐ Buy decorations before the good ones go
- ☐ Plan the menu and the drinks
- ☐ Buy the sweets – and hide them from yourself
- ☐ Test the lights, the fog machine, the speaker
- ☐ Ask about allergies on the RSVP
- ☐
- ☐

## THE NIGHT BEFORE

- ☐ Carve the pumpkins
- ☐ Chill the drinks, make ice
- ☐ Hang everything that is not food
- ☐ Charge the camera and the speaker
- ☐ Lay out costumes and the make-up
- ☐
- ☐

- ☐ Light the pumpkins at dusk
- ☐ One person on the door, one on the camera
- ☐

# WHO IS COMING AS WHAT.



**GUESTS** \_\_\_\_\_ The costume column stops two people arriving as the same thing

| #  | NAME  | COMING AS | INV                      | YES                      | NO                       | +     | ALLERGIES & NOTES |
|----|-------|-----------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|-------|-------------------|
| 01 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 02 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 03 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 04 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 05 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 06 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 07 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 08 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 09 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 10 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 11 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 12 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 13 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 14 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 15 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 16 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 17 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 18 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 19 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 20 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 21 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |
| 22 | _____ | _____     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____ | _____             |

|       |         |       |        |       |       |       |         |       |      |
|-------|---------|-------|--------|-------|-------|-------|---------|-------|------|
| _____ | INVITED | _____ | COMING | _____ | CAN'T | _____ | WAITING | _____ | KIDS |
|-------|---------|-------|--------|-------|-------|-------|---------|-------|------|

# COSTUMES & PRIZES.



**THE HOUSEHOLD** ————— What is bought, what is still missing

| WHO   | GOING AS | GOT IT                   | STILL NEEDED |
|-------|----------|--------------------------|--------------|
| _____ | _____    | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____        |
| _____ | _____    | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____        |
| _____ | _____    | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____        |
| _____ | _____    | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____        |
| _____ | _____    | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____        |
| _____ | _____    | <input type="checkbox"/> | _____        |

**MAKE-UP AND HAIR** ————— Who does it, and how long it takes

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**REPAIR KIT BY THE MIRROR** —————

- ☐ Safety pins, tape, a needle and thread
- ☐ Wipes, and the make-up used for touch-ups
- ☐ Plasters – the shoes are always the problem
- ☐ Spare tights, socks, a hair grip or six

**TEST THE WHOLE COSTUME ONCE** ————— In a mirror, sitting down

☐ \_\_\_\_\_

**THE CONTEST** ————— Announce the categories on the invitation

| CATEGORY                | WINNER | PRIZE |
|-------------------------|--------|-------|
| Best costume            | _____  | _____ |
| Funniest                | _____  | _____ |
| Most frightening        | _____  | _____ |
| Best homemade           | _____  | _____ |
| Best group              | _____  | _____ |
| Best last-minute effort | _____  | _____ |

**JUDGING** ————— Decide before the drinks

Judged by \_\_\_\_\_

Announced at \_\_\_\_\_

Prizes bought by \_\_\_\_\_

**PHOTO PLAN** ————— The costumes are the reason people came

- ☐ \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ \_\_\_\_\_

**FOR WHOEVER TURNS UP IN NORMAL CLOTHES** —————

- ☐ \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ \_\_\_\_\_



Name it on a card – half the fun is the label

## WHAT IT IS

## WHO MAKES IT

## WHAT IT IS

## WHO MAKES IT

## Count on more children than last year

## Bags

Spare bags

## One punch bowl saves an hour of pouring

## WHAT

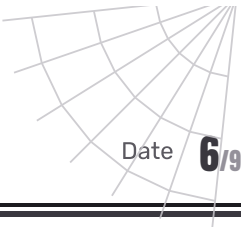
## HOW MUCH

Dry ice goes **in the bowl around the punch, never in the drink**, and never in a sealed bottle. And if there are children, keep an alcohol-free punch that looks just as good — on a night of identical black cups, that matters.

Copy them from the guest list

- ☐ More ice than seems sensible
- ☐ Cups people can tell apart, or a pen to name them
- ☐ Bin bags out early, one for bottles

# DARK, BUT YOU CAN SEE.



## ROOM BY ROOM

One idea each is plenty

WHERE WHAT HAPPENS THERE DONE

|                  |  |                          |
|------------------|--|--------------------------|
| Doorway and path |  | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Hall             |  | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Main room        |  | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Kitchen          |  | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Table            |  | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Bathroom         |  | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Garden           |  | <input type="checkbox"/> |

## LIGHT

The whole effect is lighting; the rest is props

- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐

## OUTSIDE, WHERE PEOPLE ARRIVE

- ☐ The path lit, the step visible
- ☐ A sign if the door is hard to find
- ☐ Nothing that blows over or trips people

## SOUND

- Playlist
- Starts quiet at
- Speaker & charger

### Before anyone arrives

Real candles go where nobody walks and nothing hangs – LED tea lights everywhere else, especially inside pumpkins and near costumes. Check that the stairs and the path are lit even if the rest is dark, and put the breakables away rather than around.

## PUT AWAY BEFORE THE NIGHT

- ☐
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐

## ANYTHING WITH A PLUG OR A FOG BUTTON

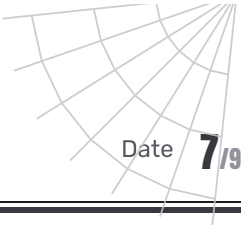
- ☐
- ☐
- ☐

## THE ENTRANCE

The first ten seconds do most of the work

- 
- 
-

# PUMPKINS.



Date **7**/9

THE PLAN

Who carves what, and where it ends up

WHAT YOU NEED

| #  | WHOSE | DESIGN | CUT                      | GOES |
|----|-------|--------|--------------------------|------|
| 1  |       |        | <input type="checkbox"/> |      |
| 2  |       |        | <input type="checkbox"/> |      |
| 3  |       |        | <input type="checkbox"/> |      |
| 4  |       |        | <input type="checkbox"/> |      |
| 5  |       |        | <input type="checkbox"/> |      |
| 6  |       |        | <input type="checkbox"/> |      |
| 7  |       |        | <input type="checkbox"/> |      |
| 8  |       |        | <input type="checkbox"/> |      |
| 9  |       |        | <input type="checkbox"/> |      |
| 10 |       |        | <input type="checkbox"/> |      |

Buy on \_\_\_\_\_ Carve on \_\_\_\_\_

Carved pumpkins last about three days indoors and about five outside in the cold. Carving on the 28th is early. Carving on the 30th is right.

IF NOBODY WANTS A KNIFE NEAR IT

- ☐ Painted instead of cut – lasts a fortnight
- ☐ Drilled dots, a light behind them
- ☐ Three stacked, tallest at the back

- ☐ Serrated knife or a carving saw
- ☐ Big spoon or scoop
- ☐ Marker for drawing the face on first
- ☐ Newspaper, and a bin bag ready
- ☐ LED tea lights, not real ones
- ☐ \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ \_\_\_\_\_

THE INSIDES

Nobody plans this and everybody regrets it

- ☐ Seeds kept, rinsed and roasted
- ☐ The rest into the garden or the food waste

SKETCH THE FACES HERE

You are copying it onto a curve



Set-up at the top, taxis at the bottom

| TIME | WHAT HAPPENS | WHO IS ON IT |
|------|--------------|--------------|
|------|--------------|--------------|

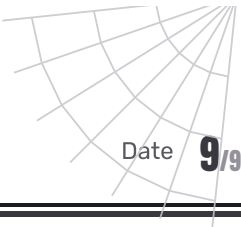
Write the time next to each

- 1 Set up finished**  
Nothing left to hang after the first guest
- 2 Doors, drinks, photographs**  
The costumes are freshest now
- 3 Food out**  
Later than feels right
- 4 Games, or the contest**  
One thing, well timed
- 5 Prizes announced**  
Before anyone starts leaving
- 6 Music up, lights lower**  
The party either lifts here or ends here
- 7 Last drinks, taxis, coats**  
Say the time out loud

- ☐ Porch light on, bowl filled, path lit
- ☐ Someone at home while the others walk
- ☐ Torch, phone, and a bag that will not split
- ☐ Route agreed, and the time you turn back
- ☐ Check the sweets before the small ones eat them



# THE FIRST OF NOVEMBER.



**WHAT WORKED** – Write it now; next October you will not remember

**WHAT TO DO DIFFERENTLY**

**THE COSTUMES: KEEP, MEND OR PASS ON**

**Today, not next year**

Decorations, costumes and sweets are half price from today. Buy next year’s this afternoon, put it in one labelled box, and write on the lid what is inside. It is the single cheapest thing on this page.

**BOUGHT IN THE SALES, IN THE BOX**

☐

☐

☐

☐

☐

**PHOTOS TO SEND TO PEOPLE**

**WHERE THE BOX LIVES**

**NEXT YEAR, ONE LINE** – Worth ten written in September